

control their content. From customised operating systems that use large, fun fonts in bright colours to applications that focus on educating children in various elementary fields. Some technology makers have, in fact, gone so far as to make age-appropriate laptops, tablets and mobiles for children.

But it isn't reasonable to expect everyone with a child to fork over tens of thousands of rupees for a laptop (such as the 'PeeWee Pivot') which is exclusively for kids. For most young families, austerity is the order of the day. Preparing and protecting your children in their use of technology doesn't necessarily mean having to spend lakhs in ensuring an arsenal of tablets, laptops and mobiles that your kids will outgrow in a couple of years. Kids, like technology, are adaptive and tend to outgrow simple toys and trifles very quickly. The bottlenecking of their technological exploration



The iPOTTY combines an iPad with an actual potty to help potty train your child

via limited tools isn't an effective way towards fostering growth. And as pedagogical research has shown, the level of engagement from a caregiving adult is directly proportional to how well a child benefits in their relationship with technology.

For readers, this means that “kid tech” also includes the tools that adults will need to better manage their children's technology usage. So broadly speaking, kids tech is the sum total of all technological tools – from OSes to applications that will help kids thrive mentally and emotionally, while assisting in the participation of adults as gatekeepers and protectors. Thankfully, there are many methods of taking charge of technology in the household with a few tricks and applications which we'll be sharing in this issue of Fast Track.